TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 12, 2022
6:30 PM

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm. Mayor Williams dedicated his term as Mayor to his friend and past Mayor Pro-tem, Kimberly Chappell-Stevens.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those in attendance in the chambers were Council Members: David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan and Brooks Barbaree. Staff Members: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Police Chief, Sean Clayton and Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman. Those attending virtually were: Mayor, Dana Williams; Council Members James Lavin and Bethany Skipper-Greer; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Utilities Billing Manager, Katina Spaulding and Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Williams stated before approving the agenda, he would like to move the nomination for Mayor Pro-tem after item number 4. Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of November 30, 2021 and December 8, 2021

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the November 30, 2021 and December 8, 2021 meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Nominations for Mayor Pro-Tem**

   Mayor Williams asked for any nomination for Mayor Pro-tem. Council Member Drohan stated this election was different than other elections. There were six good folks running for 6 good positions as alderman. Generally,

the strategy is to look at the person with the second highest number of votes to be the Mayor Pro-tem. The way things worked out this year he would like to wave that particular procedure and would like to recommend David Crenshaw for the current term. Council Member Drohan made the motion to nominate David Crenshaw as Mayor Pro-tem. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. It was open for discussion. Town Administrator Milie asked Town Attorney Barrow to clarify if this is a practice or procedure. Town Attorney Barrow explained it is not a procedure. There is no legal requirement to follow a past practice that is not grounded in policy, or an ordinance. Mayor Williams asked if there are any other nomination. Hearing none, Mayor Williams asked for a vote. **The vote was four yes and two abstained, Council Member Lavin and Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed.**

6. **Presentations:**

a) Atlantic Waste

Ben Wall presented Mallory Boyd as the new point of contact. Ms. Boyd presented the changes that were made this past year. There was a reduction to the number of days of collection. This has allowed better service with less collected 230 tons of recycling. 81.5 tons of yard debris before April. Now, yard waste and trash are collected on the same day. There have been staffing struggles but there have been reduced numbers with turnover and more consistent staffing. Two drivers and route assistants have been hired. There has been a change with recycling. Atlantic Waste are currently using Attaway Recycling. Town Administrator Milie asked if the modifications with recycling to limit the contamination resolved the issue. Ms. Boyd stated they have had success at removing the major contamination. The trailer park was having issues with recycling properly. Their contamination was causing the entire Town's recycling to be sent to the landfill. The trailer park no longer received the recycling service. Council Member Drohan asked about options for yard debris besides landfill. Ben Watson stated it can go to a C & D facility but the current option produces gas.

b) Axon Enterprise Inc.

Ross Blank and Rob Murangelo with Axon Enterprise explained the Camara and Taser Program. They explained the Taser 7 is more effective and safer for police and citizens. Town Administrator Milie asked from a liability standpoint, the availability of less than lethal force, other than reducing law suits, what are the other highlights? They explained there is a five year warranty. The Taser 7 is a two-shot weapon versus the older models with one shot. The two shot weapon improves the proper deployment to reduce possible injuries. The batteries are rechargeable. There is no additional charge for batteries as the previous contract. There is an unlimited cartridge replacement as well. They explained the camaras are upgraded at no cost.

c) McGriff Insurance

Dana Stevens – the Town's Insurance Representative explained the Town has achieved renewal. He works with Selective Insurance and Key Insurance to insure coverage for the town. The program in place will do what it needs to do to insure the Town. The new Taser and Camera Program the Police are using was helpful during the underwriting. Town Administrator Milie asked if the Town is protected as possible, including the library new lease. Mr. Stevens state yes. Council Member Crenshaw asked what is covered under crime. It was explained the crime coverage is build in to the insurance. This is a 1st party coverage and does contain a cyber coverage to protect against ransomware. Council Member Crenshaw asked about care insurance and employees using their own cars. It was explained they are covered it is an at fault accident after their primary has maxed out.

d) Town Hall and Park Beautification-

Town Administrator Milie stated due to time this topic has been moved to another meeting.

e) IT & Cyber Security Plan

Eric Fournier, with AI Technology Solutions, spoke on the Town's IT and Cyber Security Plan. He explained he has been working with the Town since 2009. Mr. Fournier explained the 2022 goals. He would like to physically control temperature in the server room. Looking for a mini split system by a third party to improve the system. He is going to work to extend the Wifi Coverage in Town Hall. He explained there are two systems being used, QS1 for utility billing and CJT for Police and Court. He is going to test back up to both those systems. He is looking into a cloud backup for the Town, since it is currently housed onsite. This is currently cost prohibitive and suggest Council starting putting it in the budget. Council Member Crenshaw asked about security. Mr. Fournier stated he would like to protect against Ransomware by adding a DNS security. This will allow control of web traffic. He will be able to monitor what sites employees are visiting. He would like to begin employee security awareness training. Council Member Crenshaw asked if it is true most attacks are after hackers have been on the system for a long time. Council Member Brooks asked what was the time frame for switching to the clouds. Mr. Fournier explained there will not be a full transition. The system is too big. He is looking at a few key vendors that offer the encrypted email. Council Member Ward asked about price. Mr. Fournier stated about $1500 per year for 10 licenses, he thinks. Mayor about linking the website with social media. This will be a separate vendor and Mr. Fournier will tie everything together.

7. **Debate Agenda:**

a) Approval of the Amended T-SPLOST MOU/IGA

Town Administrator Milie stated he does not believe this will be the final change. There was very little modifications from the approved MOU from last meeting. Town Attorney Barrow did not see anything of concern with these changes. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the amended MOU/IGA with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

b) Approval of GMA Pension Secretary

Town Administrator Milie stated his is no longer an issue and wish to strike this from the agenda.

c) Approval of Revised Outdoor Permit Application

Town Administrator Milie explained the change. The way the application reads, when someone applies for a permit, if they are going to sell alcohol, they must have a police officer. They would like to revise the amendment to not have to have the police officer unless they have an event over 20 people, and outside the regular structure. Council Member Crenshaw stated his concern with event spaces being rented out to teenagers. He thinks it is important to distinguish a small event from a big event but to leave the discretion will be up to Chief Clayton Council Member Crenshaw proposes Chief Clayton must sign off on all big events. Chief Clayton stated Police does have the ability to shut down a party. Town Attorney Barrow stated these are not ordinance changes. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the revised application with a second from**

Council Member Crenshaw. Chief Clayton stated businesses might have to reach out to another agency for off duty officers due to limited staff in Thunderbolt. **The motion passed unanimously.**

d) Approval of STR Fees

Both Council Members Drohan and Skipper-Greer recused themselves from this discussion. Town Administrator Milie explained there are two fees, initial fee and the annual fee. The initial fee is made up of staff processing time of $245, ongoing cost (host compliance, ect) $455 equaling $700. The renewal fee will be less at $580 due to a reduction in staff processing time. Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the fee with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. Resident Ed Drohan stated he has been supportive of fees and taxes for STR since the beginning. Looking at these particular numbers side by side against any other business this might be onerous. This is an exclusive task to tax. Town Administrator Milie stated he understands Council Member Drohan's point of view. This should not be the burden on the tax payer and a host compliance is needed. Code Enforcement is needed. The town is to not to lose money on this endeavor. Resident Skipper-Greer stated she concurs with Dr. Drohan. She stated she would like to know more on host compliance and QS1. Town Administrator Milie explains Host Compliance is an agency that ensures the STRs are in compliance with the ordinance. QS1 is the internal processing software being used for business licenses. She asked if there is an Owner Occupied vs. Non-Owner-Occupied cost difference. Town Administrator Milie stated there is no difference, same cost. Resident Skipper-Greer asked about the cost of the host compliance. Town Administrator Milie explained the cost for 70 STR is $10,000 annual. Resident Skipper-Greer asked if the number of STRs goes up will the fee change or stay the same. Town Administrator only if it goes to 200, the price goes up. Mel, a resident at 3217 Woodlawn asked if there is an unlimited number of STRs to be approved and what are the stipulations. Town Administrator explained there is a cap at 70 STRS and the application will be available after Friday. Trey Connor, Bannon resident asked about the STR ordinance and cap. Town Administrator Milie explained the ordinance will be added to the website on Friday for those who wish to review. **The vote was called and there were two abstentions and four approvals. The motion passed.**

8. **Finance Report**

Town Administrator Milie asked Mayor Williams if the Finance Report could be next. The CPA giving the report should not have to continue sitting here for the other items. Mayor Williams stated it was fine. Shannon Brett explained Monica Woods and Rhiannon Collins are her coworkers assigned to the Town. They have caught the financials up in QS1. The revenues for October did not make it in general ledger software but it has now been rectified. The W2s are completed and begun working on 10-99 Forms. They are working to put the 2022 Budget into QS1. Mauldin and Jenkins will be doing the audit. April is the deadline. Council Member Crenshaw asked if the information from QS1 be imported into Excel. Ms. Brett stated she will look into see if it can. Town Administrator Milie asked for their opinion on QS1 and other options. Ms. Brett stated they will provided that information at a later date. Council Member Drohan asked it they knew what happened on why the October information did not get into the system. Ms. Brett stated they did not.

e) Discussion to Extending the River Drive District

Mayor Williams explained while looking at general housekeeping of the zoning map it appears there are four parcels not included in Victory or River Drive District. He made the motion to submit this to Planning and Zoning for review. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked will they receive a map after it comes from Planning & Zoning. Town Administrator Milie stated they would. Vote was called. Council Member Crenshaw abstained from the vote. The motion passed unanimously.

f) Discussion on Water Rates

Town Administrator Milie explained the 2022 Budget is not covered by the current water and sewer rates. The Water and Sewer Committee has discussed the options of how to address a rate modification. They would like to recognize ERUs with a tiered based rate structure. When the Town purchases water from Savannah, it is higher premium. The Senior Rate for first two tiers did not go up. The main changes are on commercial. There already was going to be a modification next month on the rates but it will still not cover the 2022 Budget. Council Member Ward asked if the new rate will be implemented March 1st. Town Administrator Milie stated that is correct. Notification will go out on February bills. Council Member Drohan made motion to approve the modification of water and sewer rates with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. Council Member Drohan stated a lot of time and energy has gone into these modifications. He stated the Town has no control over how much water Johnson High School uses, but we should try to have other high users implement conservation. Conservation is the only way to control this cost. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked if are all of tier five were residential? Town Administrator Milie stated this is not the regular residential use but they are residential. The motion passed unanimously.

9. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie wanted to acknowledge Katina Spaulding for large contribution by assisting when staff came down with COVID. The fire department have addressed the roof leak.

10. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

11. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

No report

12. **Mayor and Council** – Written Reports Submitted
    a) Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan

Mayor Williams asked everyone to keep the Chappell family in their prayers. Mrs. Chappell, late Councilwoman Kimberly Chappell – Stevens' Mom, recently had a stroke and passed away.

Council Member Drohan asked if Mayor and Council could do away with written reports for Mayor and Council on the agenda. No one had issue with doing so and Clerk of Council Denion explained it was a carry over from previous Mayor and can easily be removed.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move into Executive Session. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Barbaree. The motion passed unanimously.**

13. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move back into regular session. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Approval of Lease Agreement for Library Building**

Council Member Drohan made motion to approve lease for the library building with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. Motion passed unanimously.

15. **Approval of Adding an Additional Employee Holiday**

Town Administrator Milie asked the Council to recognize an employee holiday for Juneteenth, June 19th but will be observed on the 20th this year. **Council Member Ward made the motion to accept the recommendation with a second from Council Member Drohan.** Council Member Drohan stated they could utilize this date to bring back some festivals to Thunderbolt. **The motion passed unanimously.**

16. **Adjournment:**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

The meeting adjourned at 9:13 pm.

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion